

6.7 Recording feedback and decisions

For reattempts and resubmissions, you must record the reasons why a student has been allowed to reattempt or resubmit in your centre's assessment decisions records. You must also follow our guidelines on giving feedback and record the feedback given to the student. All feedback given to the student for the purpose of a reattempt or resubmitting work must be recorded. We have created a set assignment feedback form, available on [Teach Cambridge](#), which you can use to help support this. We monitor the assessment decisions

you make. You must follow the guidelines outlined in Section 6.

We reserve the right to request the written feedback and the work in its original state. If you do not meet the requirements this will be treated as malpractice.

Neither you nor the student can add, amend or remove any work after the final mark has been submitted for moderation.

See [Section 7.3](#) for terminal assessment rules.

7 Administration

The information in this section gives an overview of the processes involved in administering this qualification. All of the following processes require you to submit something to OCR by a specific deadline. More information about the processes and deadlines involved at each stage of the assessment cycle can be found in the Administration area of the [OCR website](#).

7.1 Assessment availability

There are two assessment series available each year in January and June to all students. Students can be entered for different units in different assessment series.

All students must take the exam at a set time on the same day in a series. Certification (where students achieve the qualification) is available each January and June.

Series	Unit availability	
	Unit R093	Units R094 – R099
January	✓	✓
June	✓	✓

- First assessment for externally assessed unit R093 is January 2024.
- First assessment for NEA units R094-R099 is January 2023.
- Certification is available from January 2024.

7.2 Collecting evidence of student performance to ensure resilience in the qualifications system

Regulators have published guidance on collecting evidence of student performance as part of long-term contingency arrangements to improve the resilience of the qualifications system. You should review and consider this guidance when delivering this qualification to students at your centre.

For more detailed information on collecting evidence of student performance please visit our [website](#).

7.3 Entry rules, including Terminal Assessment

Terminal assessment rule

The externally assessed unit must be taken as terminal assessment. This means the exam for unit R093 must be taken in the student's final assessment series which could be in January or June. This exam contributes 40% of the total marks available for the qualification.

NEA units can be submitted in any series but must be submitted either before or in the same series as the externally assessed unit.

Certification entries

- For a student to achieve the qualification, you need to make a qualification certification entry (aggregation) for the student's final series
- To be eligible to receive a result, the student must have been entered for both NEA units and met the terminal assessment rule

- You can make certification entries for the final series:
 - via Interchange or EDI at the same time as unit entries for the exam
 - by submitting a post-results late certification request via Interchange before the post-results late certification deadline for the series, which is after you have received exam results for that series
- As a contingency arrangement, if you miss the post-results late certification deadline, you can make a certification entry in a future series, provided:
 - no further assessment has taken place since the terminal rule was met, and
 - you are making a certification entry only for the qualification in that future series (meaning you are not resitting or resubmitting a unit in the same series).

- You can make certification entries in the January or June series – this is the series that will appear on the qualification certificate
- Certification entries and late certification requests are always free of charge.

Post-result late certification

- Post-results late certification requests must be submitted via Interchange by the post-results deadline for the series. The deadline for each series can be found in the key dates document in the Administration area of our [website](#)
- **Note: Once the student has sat the exam in the June series, it is not possible to make a late certification request for the January series, as the final assessment series is now June.**

Resitting units before certification

- Students can take the exam before all the NEA units are completed. This is classed as a 'practice attempt'
 - 'Practice attempts' do not count towards the student's overall grade or in performance tables. The student will be issued with a unit result only
 - When the student has completed all the NEA units, if you do not make a certification entry when you enter for the exam, the exam will be classed as a practice attempt unless you make a late certification entry or a certification entry in a subsequent series
 - If a student takes the exam again after a practice attempt, the result of the latest attempt will count towards the qualification result, even if the practice attempt result was higher
- Work for each NEA assignment can be re-submitted once before the overall qualification is awarded.

Students can only resubmit work using the same assignment if the assignment is still live. We will use the best result of both attempts towards the qualification result.

- If a student takes an NEA unit multiple times using different assignments for that unit, the best result of all attempts will be used to calculate the qualification result as long as they meet the terminal assessment rule.

Retaking the qualification

- After a student has achieved a qualification result, they can resit the externally assessed unit and submit the NEA units again in a later series to improve their qualification result:
 - students can resit the exam without resubmitting the NEA units
 - students cannot resubmit the NEA units only to improve results. In order to meet terminal assessment requirements, they must also resit the exam if they are resubmitting NEA units.
- Students can only resubmit work using the **same** assignment if the assignment is still live. The live assessment dates will be shown on the front cover of the assignment. We will not accept work based on an assignment that is no longer live. If students wish to resit a unit after the live assessment date has passed, they must submit work using the new live assignment.
- The result from the first overall qualification result is used towards the performance tables.

Please refer to the Administration pages of the OCR [website](#) (Administration - OCR) for more information on early entry and discounting.

7.4 Equality Act information relating to Cambridge Nationals

The Cambridge Nationals require assessment of a broad range of skills and, as such, prepare students for further study and higher-level courses.

The Cambridge Nationals qualifications were reviewed to check if any of the competences required presented

a potential barrier to disabled students. If this was the case, the situation was reviewed again to make sure that such competences were included only where essential to the subject.

7.5 Accessibility

There can be adjustments to standard assessment arrangements on the basis of the individual needs of students. It's important that you identify as early as possible whether students have disabilities or particular difficulties that will put them at a disadvantage in the assessment situation and choose a qualification

or adjustment that allows them to demonstrate attainment.

If a student requires access arrangements in assessments that need approval from us, this must be gained in Access Arrangements Online. You must select Cambridge Nationals at time of application;

approval from GCSE or A Level applications do not extend to Cambridge Nationals. However, more than one qualification type can be selected when making an application. For guidance or support please contact the [Special Requirements Team](#).

The responsibility for providing adjustments to assessment is shared between your centre and us. Please read the JCQ booklet [Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments](#).

If you have students who need a post-examination adjustment to reflect temporary illness, indisposition or

injury when they took the assessment, please read the JCQ document [A guide to the special consideration process](#).

If you think any aspect of this qualification unfairly restricts access and progression, please email or call our Customer Support Centre.

The access arrangements permissible for use in this specification are as follows:

Access arrangement	Yes/No	Type of assessment
Reader/Computer reader	Yes	All assessments
Scribes/Speech recognition technology	Yes	All assessments
Practical assistants	Yes	All assessments
Word processors	Yes	All assessments
Communication professional	Yes	All assessments
Language modifier	Yes	All assessments
Modified question paper	Yes	Timetabled examinations
Extra time	Yes	All assessments with time limits

7.6 Requirements for making an entry

We provide information on key dates, timetables and how to submit marks on our [website](#).

Centres must be registered with OCR in order to make any entries. We recommend that centres apply to

become a registered centre with us, well in advance of making their first entries. Details on how to register with OCR can be found on our [website](#).